

Nicholas (Nic) Jones

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SUMMARY

Cybersecurity professional with experience working for leading technology companies in core security, networking, and cloud spaces. Exceptional communication, writing, and organization skills with proven ability to work in teams and independently.

CERTIFICATIONS

Information Security & Technology Certifications		Cloud & Development Certifications	
GIAC Penetration Tester (GPEN)	2026 - 2030	GitHub Foundations	2024 - 2027
GIAC Certified Intrusion Analyst (GCIA)	2026 - 2030	GitHub Actions	2024 - 2027
SANS Security Awareness Professional (SSAP)	2025 - 2029	ISACA CMMI Associate	2024 - 2027
GIAC Defensible Security Architecture (GDSA)	2025 - 2029	AWS Certified Solutions Architect Professional	2023 - 2029
GIAC Strategic Planning, Policy, and Leadership (GSTRT)	2025 - 2029	AWS Certified Security Specialty	2022 - 2025
GIAC Certified Incident Handler (GCIH)	2025 - 2029	AWS Certified Solutions Architect Associate	2020 - 2029
GIAC Security Essentials (GSEC)	2024 - 2028	Azure Security Engineer Associate (AZ-500)	2020 - 2027
ISC2 CISSP	2024 - 2027	Azure Fundamentals (AZ-900)	2020 - NED
CompTIA CySA+	2022 - 2028	AWS Certified Cloud Practitioner	2019 - 2029
ISC2 CC	2022 - 2028		
OSCP	2021 - NED		
CEH	2020 - 2026		
CompTIA Security+	2019 - 2028		
ITIL v4 Foundation	2019 - NED		
CompTIA Network+	2017 - 2028		
CompTIA A+	2017 - 2028		
CompTIA ITF+	2017 - NED		

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Information Security Engineering – SANS Technology Institute	October 2024 - Present
- In Progress, 4.0 GPA, National Cyber League (NCL) Fall 2024 Scholarship Winner, National Cyber League (NCL) Spring 2025 Scholarship Winner - Synopsis: Industry-leading technical courses and certifications with emphasis on depth in key security engineering topics.	
Master of Science in Cybersecurity – Wilmington University	August 2021 - August 2023
- Graduated, 4.0 GPA, Epsilon Pi Tau Honor Society - Synopsis: Research-oriented classes with focus on technical writing, security architecture and cybersecurity leadership.	
Bachelor of Science in Cyber & Information Security – Capitol Technology University	August 2016 - May 2020
- Graduated, 3.8 GPA, Dean's List (x4), Magna Cum Laude, Upsilon Pi Epsilon Honor Society - Synopsis: Highly technical courses aimed at building core programming, networking, and security analysis skills.	
Certificate in Electronics/Computer Information Systems Engineering – Sussex Technical High School	August 2012 - May 2016
Graduated, 3.8 GPA, Key Club, HAM Radio, SkillsUSA	

EXPERIENCE

T-Rex Solutions, LLC (Bethesda, MD - Remote)	June 2019 - Present
Information Security Manager (Jan. 2024 – Present) - Develop and execute T-Rex information security strategy and manage information security analysts - Plan and engineer security architecture for the T-Rex enterprise - Partial time on contract with Department of Education Security Engineer (Jun. 2022 – Dec. 2023) - Primary assignment on contract with Palantir Technologies as a Data Engineer - Re-architected SIEM platform for security event logging and detection Lead Information Security Analyst (May. 2020 – Jul. 2022) - Periodic penetration testing, network infrastructure management, incident response exercise development - MITRE ATT&CK adoption, ISO 27001 preparation, and managing the information security intern - Surged for a research project using AWS CDK to orchestrate multi-account AWS architectures - Cross-training team members and support to cloud technology lab projects (TLPs) Cybersecurity Analyst (Aug. 2019 – May. 2020) - Report to CISO/CIO and lead malicious email analysis, vulnerability & patch management - Cloud security architecting, security awareness training, and network monitoring	

- **Cybersecurity Intern (Jun. 2019 – Aug. 2019)**
 - Supported the security team in implementing Splunk and developing procedures, policies, compliance, and training
- U.S. Department of Education** (*Washington, D.C. - Remote*) September 2024 - Present
 - **Network Security Manager (Apr. 2025 – Present)**
 - Contract role managing network security for the Department of Education.
 - **Cloud Engineer (Sep. 2024 – Apr. 2025)**
 - Contract role supporting cloud engineering initiatives for the Department of Education.
- Palantir Technologies** (*Washington D.C. - Remote*) June 2022 - December 2023
 - **Data Engineer (Jun. 2022 – Dec. 2023)**
 - Engineered data pipelines in Palantir Foundry using Python/PySpark/TypeScript for ETL of critical government data
 - Build data pipelines to clean, normalize, and create value from data
- Synack Red Team** (*Freelance*) May 2022 - August 2024
 - **Security Researcher (May. 2022 – Aug. 2024)**
 - The Synack Red Team (SRT) is a selective bug bounty and penetration testing program
 - Test security vulnerabilities on web, host, and mobile platforms for Synack's clients
 - Team members must complete a series of technical assessments and interviews to join
- Mobius Intelligent Systems** (*Laurel, MD - Remote*) May 2019 - September 2019
 - **Applications Tester & Developer (May. 2019 – Sep. 2019)**
 - Tested and assisted in developing JavaScript, PHP, MySQL, and Python business intelligence applications for customers
- Capitol Technology University Cyber Lab** (*Laurel, MD*) March 2019 - September 2019
 - **SOC Analyst/Engineer (Mar. 2019 – Sep. 2019)**
 - Managed and developed the Cyber Lab's Security Operations Center (SOC) to keep the lab network secure
 - Promote a learning environment for other students
 - Created Splunk rules and dashboards for analysis
- ADNET Systems, Inc.** (*NASA GSFC, Greenbelt, MD*) December 2018 - May 2019
 - **Data Technician (Dec. 2018 – May. 2019)**
 - Managed CentOS and macOS systems and their logs to support heliophysics satellite missions (SDO, SOHO, STEREO)
- CSRA, Inc.** (*Falls Church, VA*) December 2017 - January 2018
 - **IT Intern (Dec. 2017 – Jan. 2018)**
 - Managed documents and IT resources to assist the government contract effort
 - Imaged and prepped Windows 10 systems and Android phones for deployment

CORE SKILLS & AREAS OF EXPERIENCE

- Information security engineering with cloud-native technologies and SIEMs, including Splunk and Sentinel
- Cloud architecture and engineering in AWS and Azure, including serverless technologies
- Python & TypeScript development in enterprise and personal project repositories
- CI/CD and DevSecOps using GitHub Workflows
- Offensive security operations and penetration testing
- Information security leadership and strategy

AWARDS & WINS

SANS Core NetWars Tournament @ SANSFIRE – 1st Place - Solo	2025 & 2026
SANS Defense NetWars Tournament @ SANSFIRE – 1st Place - Team Game	2026
SANS DFIR NetWars Tournament @ SANS Security West – 1st Place - Team Game	2026
SANS Core NetWars Tournament @ SANS Security West – 1st Place - Team Game	2026
National Cyber League (NCL) Spring 2026 Team Game – 1st Place - Experienced Students Bracket	2026
SANS NetWars Tournament of Champions @ Cyber Defense Initiative – 5th Place - Solo	2025
National Cyber League (NCL) Fall 2025 Team Game – 3rd Place - Experienced Students Bracket	2025
National Cyber League (NCL) Spring 2025 Team Game – 4th Place - Experienced Students Bracket	2025
Parsons Cyber CTF – 2nd Place	2024
CT Cubed CTF @ DEFCON – 1st Place	2023
BSides Charm Exabeam CTF – 1st Place	2023
Maryland Cyber Challenge – 3rd Place	2019
Parsons Cyber CTF – 3rd Place	2019
Parsons Cyber CTF – 1st Place	2019
SkillsUSA Delaware Web Design Competition – 1st Place	2015 & 2016
SkillsUSA National Web Design Competition – Represented Delaware in Louisville, KY	2015 & 2016
Boy Scouts of America Eagle Scout Award – 3 additional palms	2014